Manager Reflection & Practice Workbook

A companion to the "Managing Gen Z in India – Digital Playbook"

How to use this Handout?

This workbook is designed to help you **prepare, reflect, and improve** your day-to-day leadership conversations with Gen Z team members.

How to use it:

- Use one or two pages per week
- Write briefly — clarity matters more than detail
- Focus on **patterns**, not one-off incidents
- Revisit entries after conversations

This is not an evaluation tool.
It is a **thinking and preparation aid.**

You do not need to complete every page to benefit.

Write Notes

Manager Conversation Guide

A quick reference guide for everyday leadership conversations

Feedback Conversation Planner

Use this page **before giving feedback.**

Situation

What specific situation or behaviour needs feedback?
(Describe facts only)

_____

Impact

What was the impact on work, timelines, quality, or the team?

_____

Feedback Focus (Tick one)

□ Accuracy
□ Timeliness
□ Communication
□ Ownership
□ Quality
□ Professional behaviour

_____

Script I Plan to Use

(Use SAFE framework)

“_____”

Outcome I Want

What should change after this conversation?

Write Notes

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Resistance & Pushback Decoder

Use this page **when you experience pushback.**

What was said?

(Exact words, if possible)

_____

What type of resistance was this?

□ Clarification (didn't understand expectations)
□ Confidence (felt unsure or overwhelmed)
□ Capacity (too much workload)
□ Attitude (repeated refusal without reason)

_____

Clarifying Question I Could Ask

"_____"

_____

My Likely Emotional Trigger

□ Frustration
□ Impatience
□ Feeling challenged
□ Feeling disrespected

(Awareness reduces reaction.)

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Growth & Promotion Conversation Planner

Use this page **before growth or promotion discussions.**

What growth topic is being discussed?

□ Skills
□ Role readiness
□ Promotion timing
□ Career direction

Skills Required for Next Level

(List 2–3 observable skills)

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Evidence I Currently See

(Behaviours, not intent)

_____

Script I Plan to Use

"_____"

Review Timeline

When will this be revisited?

Write Notes

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Burnout & Boundary Check-in

Use this page when you sense fatigue or disengagement.

What early signs am I noticing?

□ Withdrawal
□ Irritability
□ Drop in quality
□ Silence
□ Missed deadlines

Possible Contributors

□ Workload
□ Role ambiguity
□ Personal stress (unspecified)
□ Lack of support

Check-in Question I Will Ask

“_____”

Boundary or Adjustment Needed

(If any)

Do I Need to Escalate?

□ No, monitor
□ Yes, involve HR
□ Unsure, review again

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Discipline & Follow-up Tracker

Use this page **after setting expectations or corrective action.**

Behaviour or Expectation Addressed

(Be specific)

Standard or Expectation Set

(What "good" looks like)

Timeline for Change

By when?

Follow-Up Date

Outcome After Follow-Up

□ Improved
□ Partially improved
□ No change

Next Action

□ Reinforce
□ Clarify again
□ Escalate formally

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30-Day Manager Reflection

Use this page **once every month.**

What communication shift helped the most?

Where did I still struggle?

One behaviour I will continue next month:

One habit I will consciously stop:

One reminder for myself as a manager:

Write Notes

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Closing Note - Leadership as Practice

Managing conversations — especially with a changing workforce — is not about getting every interaction right.

It is about:

- awareness before reaction
- consistency over intensity
- curiosity over control

The reflections in this playbook are not meant to be completed once and set aside.
They are intended to help you **notice patterns,** not judge yourself.

Some conversations will feel easy.
Some will feel uncomfortable.
That is part of leadership.

What matters most is:

- your willingness to pause
- your ability to listen without assumption
- your consistency in intent and behaviour

As trust builds, conversations require fewer scripts and less structure.
Judgment strengthens with experience.

Use this playbook as a **reference**, not a rulebook.
Return to it when conversations feel complex, emotional, or unclear.

Leadership is not a destination.
It is a practice — shaped one conversation at a time.

Write Notes